

# AUDIO PODCASTING

## 2026 & 2027 OFFICIAL RATING FORM

### MIDDLE SCHOOL

Judges: Using minimal (1-4 points), adequate (5-8 points), or exemplary (9-10 points) performance levels as a guideline in the rating form, record the scores earned for the event criteria in the column spaces to the right. The X1 or X2 notation in the criteria column is a multiplier factor for determining the points earned. (Example: an "adequate" score of 7 for an X1 criterion = 7 points; an "adequate" score of 7 for an X2 criterion = 14 points.) A score of zero (0) is acceptable if the minimal performance for any criterion is not met.

#### Go/No Go Specifications

- Before judging the entry, ensure that the items below are present; indicate presence with a check mark in the box.
- If an item is missing, leave the box next to the item blank and place a check mark in the box labeled ENTRY NOT EVALUATED.
- If a check mark is placed in the ENTRY NOT EVALUATED box, the entry is not to be judged.

- ☐ TIER 1 – Audio composition was submitted in proper format and accessible
- ☐ TIER 2 – PDF of the documentation portfolio was submitted
- ☐ ENTRY NOT EVALUATED

| TIER 1 – AUDIO PODCAST (70 points)                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |                                                                                                                                                                   |                                                                                                                                                         |                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | Record scores in the column spaces below. |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|
| CRITERIA                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | Minimal performance                                                                                                                                               | Adequate performance                                                                                                                                    | Exemplary performance                                                                                                                                                                                                       |                                           |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | 1-4 points                                                                                                                                                        | 5-8 points                                                                                                                                              | 9-10 points                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                           |
| <b>Creativity and Uniqueness</b><br>(X1)                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | The podcast feels like a standard piece; it does not make strides to distinguish itself from any other podcast.                                                   | The work involves some original aspects or manipulations of podcast ideas and form; it explores and includes at least one (1) or more podcast elements. | The episodes includes highly original, unusual, or imaginative episode ideas; it explores and includes at least two (2) or more podcast elements.                                                                           |                                           |
| <b>Artisanship</b><br>(X1)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | The work gives no sense of a completed podcast episode idea; there is no clear beginning, middle, or end section; the form appears random, rather than organized. | One (1) podcast element has been used to organize the episode's ideas, content, and overall form, which are somewhat coherent.                          | The episode(s) presents at least one (1) complete episode idea; the piece has a coherent and organized form with a clear beginning, middle, and end; additional elements are used to organize the episode's ideas and form. |                                           |
| <b>Energy and Style</b><br>(X2)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | The piece lacks liveliness, vitality, and vigor; there is no flair, elegance, or grace to the form.                                                               | The episodes generates an initial level of energy that appeals to the listener; the style and content is somewhat distinctive.                          | The liveliness and forcefulness of the episodes excite the listener; the style is truly unique and electrifying.                                                                                                            |                                           |
| <b>Appropriateness</b><br>(X1)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | The podcast episodes, ideas or concepts are not appropriate and acceptable for use in the event.                                                                  | The podcast idea or concept presented is acceptable and somewhat fitting.                                                                               | The podcast episodes' ideas or concepts presented are fitting and serve as an excellent example of the type of work expected.                                                                                               |                                           |
| <b>Overall Appeal</b><br>(X2)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | The work does not present an effective general impression; the podcast content does not hold the listener's interest.                                             | The podcast includes some interesting content and form ideas; the general impression is pleasant and moderately effective.                              | There is strong, interesting, and effective audio appeal; the work is designed to be enjoyed by the listeners.                                                                                                              |                                           |
| <b>TIER 1 – AUDIO PODCAST SUBTOTAL (70 points)</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                               |                                                                                                                                                                   |                                                                                                                                                         |                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |                                           |
| <p>Rules violations (a deduction of 20% of the total possible points for the above sections) must be initialed by the judge, coordinator, and manager of the event. Record the deduction in the space to the right.</p> <p>Indicate the rule violated: _____</p> |                                                                                                                                                                   |                                                                                                                                                         |                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |                                           |

| TIME DEDUCTIONS                                                                                                                                                                 |  |                                     |  |                      |  |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--|-------------------------------------|--|----------------------|--|
| There will be a five (5) point deduction for each fifteen (15) seconds under the minimum time or each fifteen (15) seconds over the maximum time allowed for the audio podcast. |  |                                     |  |                      |  |
| Total time under                                                                                                                                                                |  | Fifteen (15)-second intervals under |  | Under time deduction |  |
| Total time over                                                                                                                                                                 |  | Fifteen (15)-second intervals over  |  | Over time deduction  |  |
| TOTAL TIME DEDUCTION                                                                                                                                                            |  |                                     |  |                      |  |

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| TIER 1 – SUBTOTAL (70 points) |  |
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| TIER 2 – DOCUMENTATION PORTFOLIO (50 points)          |                                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                               |                                                                                                                                                                              | Record scores<br>in the column<br>spaces below. |
|-------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|
| CRITERIA                                              | Minimal performance                                                                                                              | Adequate performance                                                                                                          | Exemplary performance                                                                                                                                                        |                                                 |
|                                                       | 1-4 points                                                                                                                       | 5-8 points                                                                                                                    | 9-10 points                                                                                                                                                                  |                                                 |
| Portfolio Components<br>(X1)                          | Portfolio is unorganized and/or is missing three (3) or more components.                                                         | Portfolio has most components and is generally organized per the order of the event guide listing; it has sufficient content. | All components are included in the portfolio; content and organization per the order of the event guide listing are excellent.                                               |                                                 |
| Podcast Cover Art<br>(X2)                             | The cover art is present, but not creative and doesn't reflect the podcast.                                                      | The cover art is present and the correct size; the cover art is of good quality and creates the desire to enjoy the podcast.  | The cover art is present and the correct size; the cover art is exemplary and truly promotes the podcast; it is evident that the team connects the cover art to the podcast. |                                                 |
| Work Log and Self-Evaluation<br>(X1)                  | The Work Log and/or self-evaluation are incomplete, and/or missing key components.                                               | The Work Log and/or self-evaluation are somewhat complete and incorporate reflections and efforts of the team.                | A complete and concisely written Work Log and self-evaluation are provided and incorporate the efforts and reflections of the team.                                          |                                                 |
| Track Timeline<br>(X1)                                | The track timeline is incomplete and/or not created correctly; the timeline does not correlate with the actual music production. | The track timeline is largely complete and attempts to correlate with the actual podcast production.                          | The track timeline is of exemplary quality; it correlates completely with the podcast production and is easy to follow.                                                      |                                                 |
| TIER 2 – DOCUMENTATION PORTFOLIO SUBTOTAL (50 points) |                                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                               |                                                                                                                                                                              |                                                 |

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| Rules violations (a deduction of 20% of the total possible points for the above sections) must be initialed by the judge, coordinator, and manager of the event. Record the deduction in the space to the right. |  |
| Indicate the rule violated: _____                                                                                                                                                                                |  |

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| PRELIMINARY SUBTOTAL (120 points) |  |
|-----------------------------------|--|

| SEMIFINAL ON-SITE PODCAST (70 points)                 |                                                                                                                                                                   |                                                                                                                                                         |                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | Record scores<br>in the column<br>spaces below. |
|-------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|
| CRITERIA                                              | Minimal performance                                                                                                                                               | Adequate performance                                                                                                                                    | Exemplary performance                                                                                                                                                                                                       |                                                 |
|                                                       | 1-4 points                                                                                                                                                        | 5-8 points                                                                                                                                              | 9-10 points                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                 |
| <b>Creativity and Uniqueness</b><br>(X1)              | The podcast feels like a standard piece; it does not make strides to distinguish itself from any other podcast.                                                   | The work involves some original aspects or manipulations of podcast ideas and form; it explores and includes at least one (1) or more podcast elements. | The episodes include highly original, unusual, or imaginative episode ideas; it explores and includes at least two (2) or more podcast elements.                                                                            |                                                 |
| <b>Artisanship</b><br>(X1)                            | The work gives no sense of a completed podcast episode idea; there is no clear beginning, middle, or end section; the form appears random, rather than organized. | One (1) podcast element has been used to organize the episode's ideas, content, and overall form, which are somewhat coherent.                          | The episode(s) presents at least one (1) complete episode idea; the piece has a coherent and organized form with a clear beginning, middle, and end; additional elements are used to organize the episode's ideas and form. |                                                 |
| <b>Energy and Style</b><br>(X2)                       | The piece lacks liveliness, vitality, and vigor; there is no flair, elegance, or grace to the form.                                                               | The episodes generate an initial level of energy that appeals to the listener; the style and content is somewhat distinctive.                           | The liveliness and forcefulness of the episodes excite the listener; the style is truly unique and electrifying.                                                                                                            |                                                 |
| <b>Appropriateness</b><br>(X1)                        | The podcast episodes, ideas or concepts are not appropriate and acceptable for use in the event.                                                                  | The podcast idea or concept presented is acceptable and somewhat fitting.                                                                               | The podcast episodes' ideas or concepts presented are fitting and serve as an excellent example of the type of work expected.                                                                                               |                                                 |
| <b>Overall Appeal</b><br>(X2)                         | The work does not present an effective general impression; the podcast content does not hold the listener's interest.                                             | The podcast includes some interesting content and form ideas; the general impression is pleasant and moderately effective.                              | There is strong, interesting, and effective audio appeal; the work is designed to be enjoyed by the listeners.                                                                                                              |                                                 |
| <b>SEMIFINAL ON-SITE PODCAST SUBTOTAL (70 points)</b> |                                                                                                                                                                   |                                                                                                                                                         |                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |                                                 |

| TIME DEDUCTIONS                                                                                                                                                                                                  |  |                                     |  |                      |  |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--|-------------------------------------|--|----------------------|--|
| There will be a five (5) point deduction for each fifteen (15) seconds under the minimum time or each fifteen (15) seconds over the maximum time allowed for the audio podcast.                                  |  |                                     |  |                      |  |
| Total time under                                                                                                                                                                                                 |  | Fifteen (15)-second intervals under |  | Under time deduction |  |
| Total time over                                                                                                                                                                                                  |  | Fifteen (15)-second intervals over  |  | Over time deduction  |  |
| <b>TOTAL TIME DEDUCTION</b>                                                                                                                                                                                      |  |                                     |  |                      |  |
| Rules violations (a deduction of 20% of the total possible points for the above sections) must be initialed by the judge, coordinator, and manager of the event. Record the deduction in the space to the right. |  |                                     |  |                      |  |
| Indicate the rule violated: _____                                                                                                                                                                                |  |                                     |  |                      |  |

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| <b>SEMIFINAL SUBTOTAL (70 points)</b> |  |
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| <b>To arrive at the TOTAL score, add any subtotals and subtract rules violation points, as necessary.</b> | <b>TOTAL (190 points)</b> |  |
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Comments:

I certify these results to be true and accurate to the best of my knowledge.

**JUDGE**

Printed name: \_\_\_\_\_ Signature: \_\_\_\_\_